

Policy Information

Policy Name	Incident Response Policy
Policy Number	IR-001
Effective Date	June 14, 2026
Revision	1.0

Portfolio Note: This document is an academic cybersecurity policy writing sample based on

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3. It is not an official organizational policy.

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Incident Response Policy

I. Authority

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Govern Function

This Incident Response Policy is established under the authority of organizational management and the Information Security Department. The organization has the responsibility to protect its information systems, data, users, and operations from cybersecurity incidents that may affect confidentiality, integrity, or availability.

II. Purpose

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Govern, Respond, and Recover Functions

The purpose of this policy is to establish requirements for reporting, responding to, documenting, and recovering from cybersecurity incidents. The organization shall maintain an incident response process to ensure cybersecurity incidents are reported, reviewed, contained, resolved, and documented within the timeframes established by the organization's incident response procedures.

III. Scope

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Identify and Protect Functions

This policy applies to all employees, students, contractors, third-party users, systems, networks, applications, and data owned or used by the organization. This policy applies to cybersecurity incidents such as unauthorized access, malware, phishing, account compromise, data loss, service disruption, and other security events.

IV. Roles and Responsibilities

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Govern and Respond Functions

Management: Responsible for supporting the incident response program, assigning appropriate resources, and ensuring that this policy is followed.

The Information Security Team: Responsible for reviewing reported incidents, investigating security events, coordinating response activities, documenting findings, and recommending improvements.

Information Technology Staff: Responsible for supporting containment, recovery, system restoration, account management, and other technical actions as directed by the incident response process.

Users: Responsible for reporting suspicious activity, phishing attempts, lost or stolen devices, unauthorized access, or unusual system behavior as soon as possible.

V. Policy Statements

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Detect, Respond, and Recover Functions

The organization shall maintain an incident response process to ensure cybersecurity incidents are reported, reviewed, contained, resolved, and documented.

All users shall report suspected cybersecurity incidents immediately to the Information Security Team, IT help desk, supervisor, or another approved reporting contact.

Users shall not attempt to investigate, delete evidence, or resolve suspected incidents unless instructed by authorized personnel.

Confirmed incidents shall be classified based on severity, impact, affected systems, and risk to organizational data or operations.

The organization shall take appropriate action to contain incidents and reduce further damage.

Affected systems, accounts, or services shall not be returned to normal operation until authorized personnel determine that recovery actions have been completed.

All confirmed incidents shall be documented, including the incident description, timeline, affected systems, actions taken, and final resolution.

The organization shall review incidents after resolution to identify lessons learned and improve future incident response activities.

VI. Definitions

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Incident Response Terminology and Cybersecurity Framework
Functions

Cybersecurity Incident: An event that may negatively affect the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of an organization's systems, networks, data, or services.

Incident Response: The organized process of preparing for, detecting, responding to, and recovering from cybersecurity incidents.

Confidentiality: The protection of information from unauthorized access or disclosure.

Integrity: The protection of information from unauthorized modification or destruction.

Availability: The ability of authorized users to access systems, data, and services when needed.

Containment: Actions taken to limit the damage or spread of a cybersecurity incident.

Recovery: Actions taken to restore affected systems, accounts, or services to normal operation.

VII. Revision History

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Govern Function and Continuous Improvement Concepts

Version	Date	Description
1.0	June 14, 2026	Initial Creation of Incident Response Policy based on NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3.

VIII. References

National Institute of Standards and Technology. (2025). *Incident Response Recommendations and Considerations for Cybersecurity Risk Management: A CSF 2.0 Community Profile* (NIST Special Publication 800-61 Revision 3). U.S. Department of Commerce.
<https://doi.org/10.6028/NIST.SP.800-61r3>